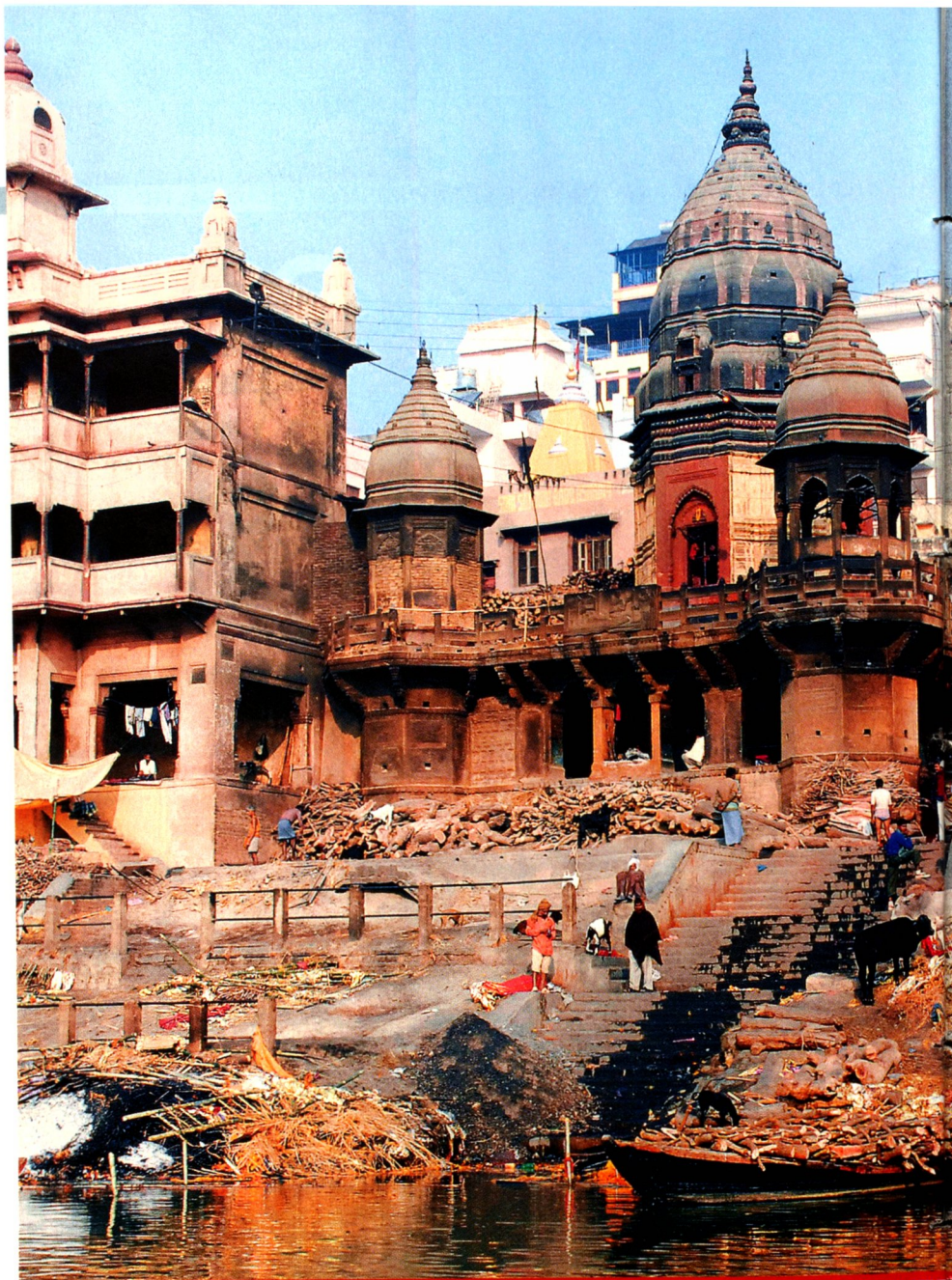




THE GANGA
After Rs 780 crore, the holy Ganga is still no cleaner. Now, even with the World Bank agreeing to an initial assistance of \$1 billion, it's doubtful if money can bring the river back to its health

OVER THE PAST TWO DECADES, POLLUTION IN THE GANGA RIVER

Minister Sheila Dikshit, "The Yamuna Action Plan I and II have not yielded the desired results despite crores of rupees being spent on them. Though teams were sent to see the Thames and Seine, it would take another seven-eight years for the Yamuna to be like them." The Yamuna's violation continues as it moves eastward. In Mathura, the Yamuna is getting silted as pillars are being constructed by the Mathura-Vrindavan Development Authority in the middle of

the riverbed as part of a road which will be parallel to the 16th-century ghats.

Chennai's four sewage treatment plants take care of 264 MLD of sewage instead of the required 530 MLD. In Jharkhand, the presence of unregulated mining and mineral industries have silted the Subarnarekha. It is not as if these incidents are the fallout of India Shining. The National River Conservation Plan (NRCP) was launched in 1995 to clean up major rivers.